

Android users, beware of battery apps!

Beware Android users! Hackers are again on the prowl! This time they have added apps in the Android market that can help replenish your smartphone's battery.

IT security solution firm, Symantec, has figured out that the apps actually help in reviving your battery's life but also steal important information. The company released an 'Intelligence Report' for September 2012, which stated that, "They steal critical information from your device."

The report further added that, "The high processing power of embedded CPUs and large, bright LCD screens, coupled with frequent usage of apps, make the battery's life a perennial problem for device users. This has spawned a whole genre of applications aimed at addressing this problem." These apps actually allow you to have a better battery status, notify you when the battery is going down, and automatically turn off features and apps that are not necessary. "We found a bunch of apps that promise to charge the battery using solar energy. They claim that they can turn your phone screen into a solar charger," the Symantec report said.

The report advises users to keep away from such apps till manufacturers actually install them on the phones. Till then, it is advisable to continue charging the phone using regular chargers. "If an app requests permissions that seem out of the ordinary for what it is supposed to do, then don't install it," it recommended.

Zenwalk Linux 7.2 released

Version 7.2 of Zenwalk Linux is now available. This release mainly aims at improving the overall performance of the distribution, which is based on Slackware, the oldest Linux distribution. "We are happy to release Zenwalk 7.2. After several months of rescheduling, we think it's time to let this new jet fly," said an official blog posting.

"Zenwalk 7.2 is loyal to its design: providing one application per task, everything needed to work, play, code and create, in a single 700 MB ISO image, through a 10-minute automatic install process on any recent computer. Zenwalk aims to be really fast among the modern Linux desktops, due to many optimisations at the kernel, applications and desktop level. The challenge that we faced, and which caused a delay in the 7.2 release date, was to achieve 100 per cent Slackware-Linux compatibility while keeping most of the optimisations that were introduced during the past few years of development (from 2004). Zenwalk 7.2 runs on kernel 3.4.8 with a BFS scheduler. The Zenwalk desktop is based on the XFCE 4.10, GTK 2.24.10, and the 3.4.4 team. It has a unique look and feel, and perfect ergonomic integration of the application set comprising Libreoffice 3.6.2, Firefox/Thunderbird 15.0.1, The Gimp 2.8.2 and much more... The Netpkg package manager has been improved with support for multiple mirrors and better performance," the blogpost reported.

Zenwalk is a GNU/Linux operating system, designed to provide the following characteristics:

- Modern and user-friendly (latest stable software, selected applications)
- Very fast (optimised for performance capabilities).
- Rational (one mainstream application for each task).
- Complete (full development, desktop and multimedia environment)
- Evolutionary (advanced network package management tool - Netpkg).



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